

SYLLABUS

Time/place	Lecture: Tuesday & Thursdays, 4:00pm-5:50pm Pacific Time, Haines A44 Section: Fridays, 8:00am-8:50am (Haines 122) or 9:00am-9:50am (Kaplan A32)	
Taught by	Prof.: Sam Zukoff [ˈsæm ˈzuˌkɒf] pronouns: he/him	T.A.: John McGahay [ˈdʒɑn məˈgeɪhi] pronouns: he/him
Student hours	Wednesdays 2pm-4pm Campbell 2210B	TBD
Email	samzukoff@ucla.edu	jmcgahay@g.ucla.edu
Website	log in to bruinlearn.ucla.edu (please communicate with us by email, not through Canvas messages)	

This course aims to get you to the point where you can understand current **articles and talks** in phonology, conduct your **own research** in phonology, use current phonological frameworks for your research and studies in other areas of language, and apply your knowledge of phonology to **practical problems**. We will cover some of the topics from 120A at a higher level, as well as new topics, from the perspective of **phonological constraints**.

What to remember from previous courses

- Use phonetic symbols
- Use phonetic terms for place of articulation, manner of articulation, phonation type, vowel height/advancement/rounding, etc.
 - **You can review in Chapter 2 of G&J**
- Given surface data...
 - Identify and analyze *phonotactic patterns*
 - Identify and analyze *alternations*
 - Decide underlying forms and morpheme boundaries (**review Ch. 7 of G&J**)
- Use *features* to capture classes of sounds that pattern together (**review Ch. 5 & 6 of G&J**)
- Identify probable *syllable structure*
- Determine what your analysis *predicts*, and what data could test those predictions
- Compare different analyses of the same data
- *Explain* your analysis, with well-chosen *example derivations*
- Project skills
 - Find and (with help) understand a published source describing phonology of a language you're interested in
 - Recruit a speaker
 - Make and transcribe a decent-quality recording

- Use Praat to verify transcriptions acoustically [I'll try to post a video tutorial if anyone hasn't used Praat]
- Write a paper describing your original phonological research

What is knowing phonology useful for?

- Studying other aspects of language (acquisition, processing, bilingualism, neurolinguistics...)
- Language learning
- Language teaching
- Education, especially reading and language arts
- Speech and language therapy
- Language technology (speech synthesis, speech recognition)
- Studying and creating literature, especially poetry and song lyrics

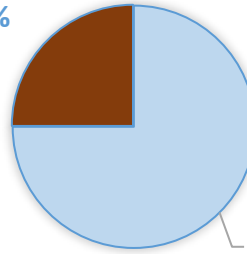
What higher-level skills will we work on?

- Formulating, and communicating in writing, a clear description and analysis of a set of data
- Evaluating and comparing different analyses of the same data
- Metacognitive skills: assessing your knowledge and skills, monitoring your progress

Course requirements/grades

Project includes **milestones** you turn in (by uploading to BruinLearn) throughout the quarter and get individual feedback on.

Project:
25%



Skills mastery:
75%

Skills mastery

There are **37 skills** to be mastered in this course. To show that you've mastered a skill, correctly answer a question testing it on a quiz, exam, or assignment. You'll get **multiple opportunities** to demonstrate mastery of each skill, with **no penalty** for wrong answers.

We'll talk more about this, and I'll show you how the **gradebook** works and how to use it to track your progress. In the meantime, you can see the **list of skills** on BruinLearn.

Why do this? A growing body of research suggests that traditional grading is inaccurate at assessing mastery, and less effective in promoting learning. I want us to do better.

UCLA folks published an article about it! See Zuraw, Aly, Lin & Royer 2019, here: <https://linguistics.ucla.edu/people/Zuraw/#Papers>

How does this translate into a number?

- Middle of B range (85%): demonstrate proficiency on all 37 skills
- Middle of A range (95%): proficiency on all 37 skills, plus advanced proficiency on 10
- formula: $final_skills_percentage = 48 + \#_of_skills_mastered + \#_of_skills_advanced$

Opportunities you'll get to demonstrate skills

- 7 **quizzes** (we may add more if needed)
 - On BruinLearn, to be completed on your own time, within a 48-hour window. Open book, open notes.
- 6 **homework** assignments
 - Include advanced sections, for demonstrating advanced proficiency
- **Midterm** exam (online like quizzes): will provide opportunities for all skills seen so far, except those that everyone is already proficient in.
- **Final** exam (online, during exam slot): will provide opportunities for all skills, except those that everyone is already proficient in.
- The only penalty for missing a quiz, homework, or exam is missed opportunity.

Policy stuff and mechanics

There are two philosophies of grading: an assessment of how well you've mastered the material vs. an incentive system to make you do things that should help you master the material. I'm going with the "assessment" model, so there are no explicit grades for **attendance**. If you miss class though, it does hurt your learning and thus your grade.

Homework assignments will be posted on BruinLearn at least a week in advance, and you'll upload your answers as a PDF by Section on Friday.

You're encouraged to discuss the homework together. But solutions must be **written individually**.

Quizzes will be posted on BruinLearn. They'll require you to open a Word document (.docx), save your own copy, fill it in, make a PDF, and upload the PDF. [I'll post a PDF of the quiz too so you can double check for formatting issues.]

You can practice all this with a practice quiz. You'll have a 30-minute window to complete the real quizzes, any time from **9am Monday to 4pm Tuesday** (Pacific Time).

If you have a **time accommodation**, please have CAE notify me ASAP so I can set it up. In the quizzes, you can consult your book and notes, but not each other or any other person.

Same format for **midterm** and **final exam**, except different schedule (see course schedule grid below).

Late passes: It's not feasible for your TA to just accept homework whenever, but at the same time we need to build in flexibility. Everyone gets **two** late passes that allow you to turn in a homework assignment, or do a quiz, **up to a week late**. [Late HW's must be turned in before Section the following week.] I suggest waiting to spend them until some week when your circumstances are more difficult than your baseline. When you want to spend a late pass, just e-mail Sam and John to let us know. BruinLearn will let you submit late work, but it will count it only if you've told us you want to spend a late pass on that piece of work.

What happens **if you miss a quiz**? Don't worry about it! You can try those same skills again in the future.

Suspected cases of **plagiarism or other cheating** will be sent directly to the Dean of Students; I believe it is fairer for them to talk to the student and weigh the evidence than for me to. See project instructions for tips on how to avoid plagiarism.

You have the opportunity to earn **2 extra credit points** by participating in an experiment through the Psychology Department Subject Pool. Serving as a subject in an experiment provides students with direct exposure to linguistic and psychological research. By participating in experiments, you will have the opportunity to contribute to on-going research at UCLA while getting an inside glimpse of how research studies are conducted. The posting and scheduling of experiments is handled via the Psychology Department Subject Pool system at <http://ucla.sona-systems.com/>. More information on how to use the system can be found at <http://www.psych.ucla.edu/undergraduate/subject-pool-experiment-participation>. One half credit is given for every half hour of experiment participation. If you complete 4 hours of experiment(s), you will have 2 points added to your final grade at the end of the quarter. NOTE: Before signing up for experiments, you **MUST** select the course for which you want your experiment credits to count. All experiments for Fall Quarter 2023 must be completed by March 14, 2024 (Thursday of Week 10).

Secrets of success

Attend class and section

Phonology is one of those areas where understanding the concepts isn't enough—you really have to *do* it.

If you have to miss a class, the detailed handouts will let you see what you missed.

Block out time for course work

Take some time to block out your ideal week for this quarter. For each hour, do you plan to be sleeping? Commuting? In class? Working? Relaxing? **Doing class work?**

This tells you if your quarter is feasible: if you weren't able to block out a few hours a week for "work on LING 165A", then you've got a problem.

It also lets you be present with whatever you're doing, since you know that's your time to do that thing, and other activities have time set aside for them.

Talk to Sam, John, and each other

...if you don't understand something, you have an idea, you disagree with or are intrigued by something you've read ...

Start with the **Discussion forum** on BruinLearn. Who knows, maybe a fellow student will answer your question before John or Sam gets there.

Don't be shy about using our **student hours**. They are time we have set aside for you!

Manage your attention

All the research seems to show that (i) humans think we're good at multi-tasking, and (ii) humans are **really bad at multi-tasking**. Try to give class your full attention (that means put away devices, turn off notifications)—you'll learn more and it'll also exercise for your attention muscles.

I recommend taking notes on the paper handout itself rather than on a laptop. It will work better practically, and reduce distraction to you and your neighbors.

(Also, in this classroom the desks aren't really big enough for more than the handout.)

Read the textbooks—strategically

Educational research suggests that **repeated reading is not a good study strategy**—the material begins to look very familiar, producing a false sense of mastery.

But reading the chapter once—noting your questions and comments—and then consulting it when you're unclear on something is extremely beneficial!

Reading the textbooks will give you a chance to see more examples than in class, and to work through them at your own pace.

Textbooks

For this class, we will be using two textbooks.

The primary textbook is:

[G&J] **Gussenhoven & Jacobs (2017) *Understanding Phonology*, 4th edition**

The eBook is available for \$25 through the UCLA Inclusive Access program. The details of how this program works can be found at the bottom of this page. **[Read this very carefully.]** If you would prefer a physical copy, it can be found online for < \$50.



The secondary textbook is:

[K] **Kager (1999) *Optimality Theory***

This will serve as a supplement to G&J, especially in the early part of the course. I will make a pdf of this book available on Bruin Learn. You of course can buy a physical copy of this book online if you wish.

UCLA Inclusive Access program

This course is part of the UCLA Inclusive Access program. Your course materials are being automatically provided to you, digitally, through Bruin Learn by the first day of class or upon enrollment. The materials are being provided at a reduced and competitive price. You will receive email from the UCLA Store (UCLA Store no-reply@verbasoftware.com) with program details and cost sent directly to your email address on file with the Registrar. It is ***your responsibility*** to read all communication coming from the bookstore. Check your spam folder if not received.

Everyone enrolled in this course is automatically a participant to start and will have access to the materials through Week 2. Those remaining in the program after Week 2 will be billed for the materials directly to their BruinBill account and will continue to have accesses to the course materials. ***If you do not wish to participate in Inclusive Access, you must opt-out by the Friday of Week 2 deadline or you will be billed.*** Those who opt-out will lose access to the digital materials and will be responsible for obtaining the materials on their own.

Do not pay for your materials through the publisher website unless you are opting out of Inclusive Access. All Inclusive Access course materials will be billed to your BruinBill account.

Course outline

Week	Date		Topics	Readings	Work (due Fridays)
Unit 1: Constraints and Optimality Theory					
1	Jan. 9		Constraints in phonology: Optimality Theory - Translating from rules to constraints - Why use constraints?	G&J Ch. 4.4-4.6 K Ch. 1.1-1.4	<i>nothing due</i>
	Jan. 11				[No section this week]
2	Jan. 16		Optimality Theory basics - Syllable structure constraints - Factorial typology	K Ch. 3	HW 1: OT warmup Project: Topic declaration
	Jan. 18				
3	Jan. 23	Quiz #1	Segmental phonology - Contrast, phonemes & allophones in OT - Richness of the Base	K Ch. 1.5-1.9 K Ch. 2	HW 2: OT syllables
	Jan. 25				
Unit 2: Autosegmental Phonology and Prosodic Phonology					
4	Jan. 30	Quiz #2	<i>No class – work on Project</i>	G&J Ch. 10 G&J Ch. 14	HW 3: OT segments Project: Source report
	Feb. 1		Autosegmental phonology - Tone - Harmony, spreading, and feature geometry		
5	Feb. 6	Quiz #3	Stress in OT - Alternating stress, weight sensitivity - Feet and prosodic structure	G&J Ch. 11 K Ch. 4	HW 4: Tone Project: Elicitation plan
	Feb. 8				
6	Feb. 13		Catch-up and midterm review	<i>no reading</i>	<i>nothing due</i>
	Feb. 15	MIDTERM EXAM (online, <u>no class</u>): Take it sometime between 8:00am Feb. 15 and 8:00pm Feb. 17. You'll have 3 hours (should only take 2).			[No section this week]
Unit 3: Cyclicity and Opacity in Lexical Phonology					
7	Feb. 20	Quiz #4	Lexical phonology: lexical vs postlexical Level ordering and strata	G&J Ch. 8	Project: Elicitation report
	Feb. 22				
8	Feb. 27	Quiz #5	Opacity in (Stratal) OT Cyclic and non-cyclic opacity	G&J Ch. 13 (K Ch. 6)	HW 5: Lexical phonology
	Feb. 29				
Unit 4: Phonological Domains in OT					
9	Mar. 5	Quiz #6	Phonology above the word - Domains bigger than the word - Phonology-syntax interface	G&J Ch. 12	Project: Draft abstract
	Mar. 7				
10	Mar. 12	Quiz #7	Wrap-up, review, and prospect	<i>no reading</i>	HW 6: Phonology above the word
	Mar. 14		<i>No class – study on your own</i>		
Exam Week			FINAL EXAM (ONLINE): Take it sometime between 8:00am March 19 and 8:00pm March 21. You'll have 4 hours (should only take 3).		Project: Turn in paper and recording by midnight Friday

Standard messages

These are information that applies to all your UCLA classes

From the Title IX office

“Title IX prohibits gender discrimination, including sexual harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking. If you have experienced sexual harassment or sexual violence, you can receive confidential support and advocacy at the CARE Advocacy Office for Sexual and Gender-Based Violence, 1st Floor Wooden Center West, CAREadvocate@caps.ucla.edu, (310) 206-2465. In addition, Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) provides confidential counseling to all students and can be reached 24/7 at (310) 825-0768. You can also report sexual violence or sexual harassment directly to the University’s Title IX Coordinator, 2241 Murphy Hall, titleix@conet.ucla.edu, (310) 206-3417. Reports to law enforcement can be made to UCPD at (310) 825-1491.

Faculty and TAs are required under the UC Policy on Sexual Violence and Sexual Harassment to inform the Title IX Coordinator should they become aware that you or any other student has experienced sexual violence or sexual harassment.”

From the library

“Research Help

Looking for help with your papers, assignments, and research projects? You can drop by one of our libraries, schedule a free research consultation at the Inquiry Labs, or get research help online 24/7. See <http://library.ucla.edu/questions> for more information”

From CAPS

“Mental Health & Wellness

As a student you may experience a range of issues that can cause barriers to learning, such as strained relationships, increased anxiety, alcohol/drug problems, depression, difficulty concentrating and/or lack of motivation. These mental health concerns or stressful events may lead to diminished academic performance or reduce a student's ability to participate in daily activities. UC offers services to assist you with addressing these and other concerns you may be experiencing. If you or someone you know are suffering from any of the aforementioned conditions, consider utilizing the confidential mental health services available on campus. I encourage you to reach out to the Counseling Center for support (www.counseling.ucla.edu and 310-825-0768, available 24/7). An on campus counselor or after-hours clinician is available 24/7”

From CAE

“Students needing academic accommodations based on a disability should contact the Center for Accessible Education (CAE) at (310)825-1501 or in person at Murphy Hall A255. When possible, students should contact the CAE within the first two weeks of the term as reasonable notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. For more information visit www.cae.ucla.edu.”

From the UWC

“The Undergraduate Writing Center offers UCLA undergraduates one-on-one sessions on their writing. The Center is staffed by peer learning facilitators (PLFs), undergraduates who are trained to help at any stage in the writing process and with writing assignments from across the curriculum. PLFs tailor appointments to the concerns of each writer.

Scheduled appointments: Work in person with a Peer Learning Facilitator (PLF)

Walk-in appointments: Walk in to discuss a small issue or an entire paper

Online Writing Center: Talk via Google Hangouts with a Peer Learning Facilitator (PLF)

Phone: 310-206-1320; e-mail: wcenter@g.ucla.edu

Book an Appointment: www.wp.ucla.edu/uwc”